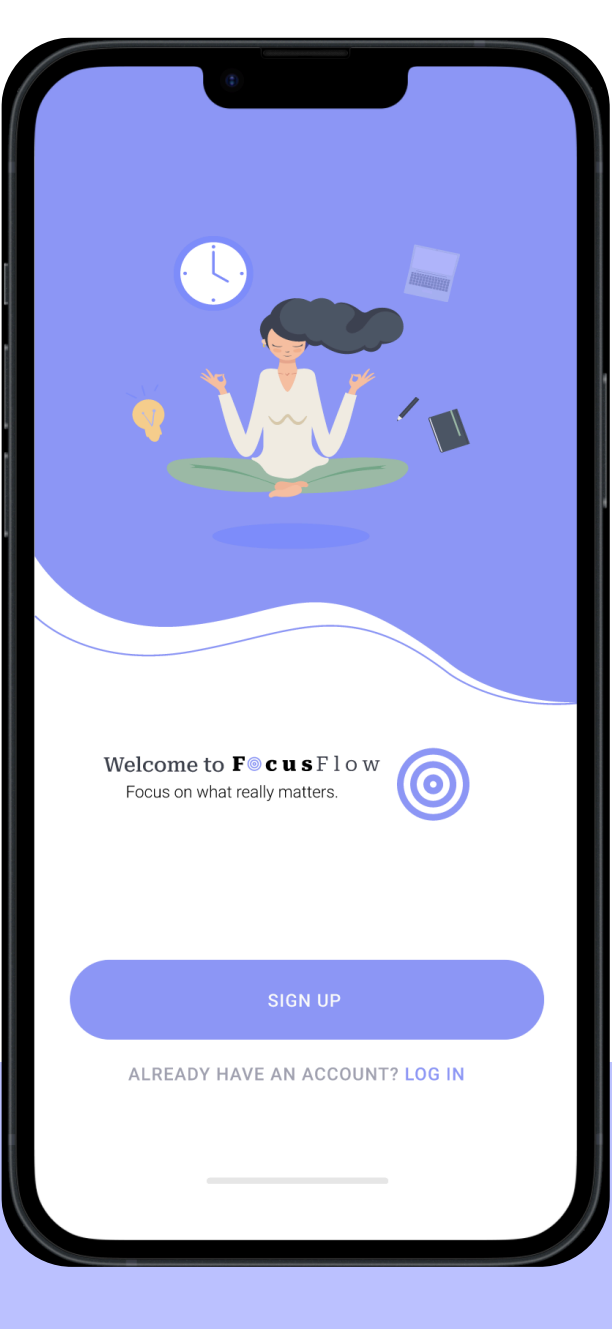
FocusFlow

Focus on what really matters!


Welcome to FocusFlow
Focus on what really matters.
SIGN UP
ALREADY HAVE AN ACCOUNT? LOG IN

The User Problem

Productivity, focus, and mental clarity are increasingly challenging in a world full of digital distractions. Our interviews revealed that users struggle with balancing focus, productivity, and relaxation in a healthy manner.

How did we know this was a problem?

User Interviews

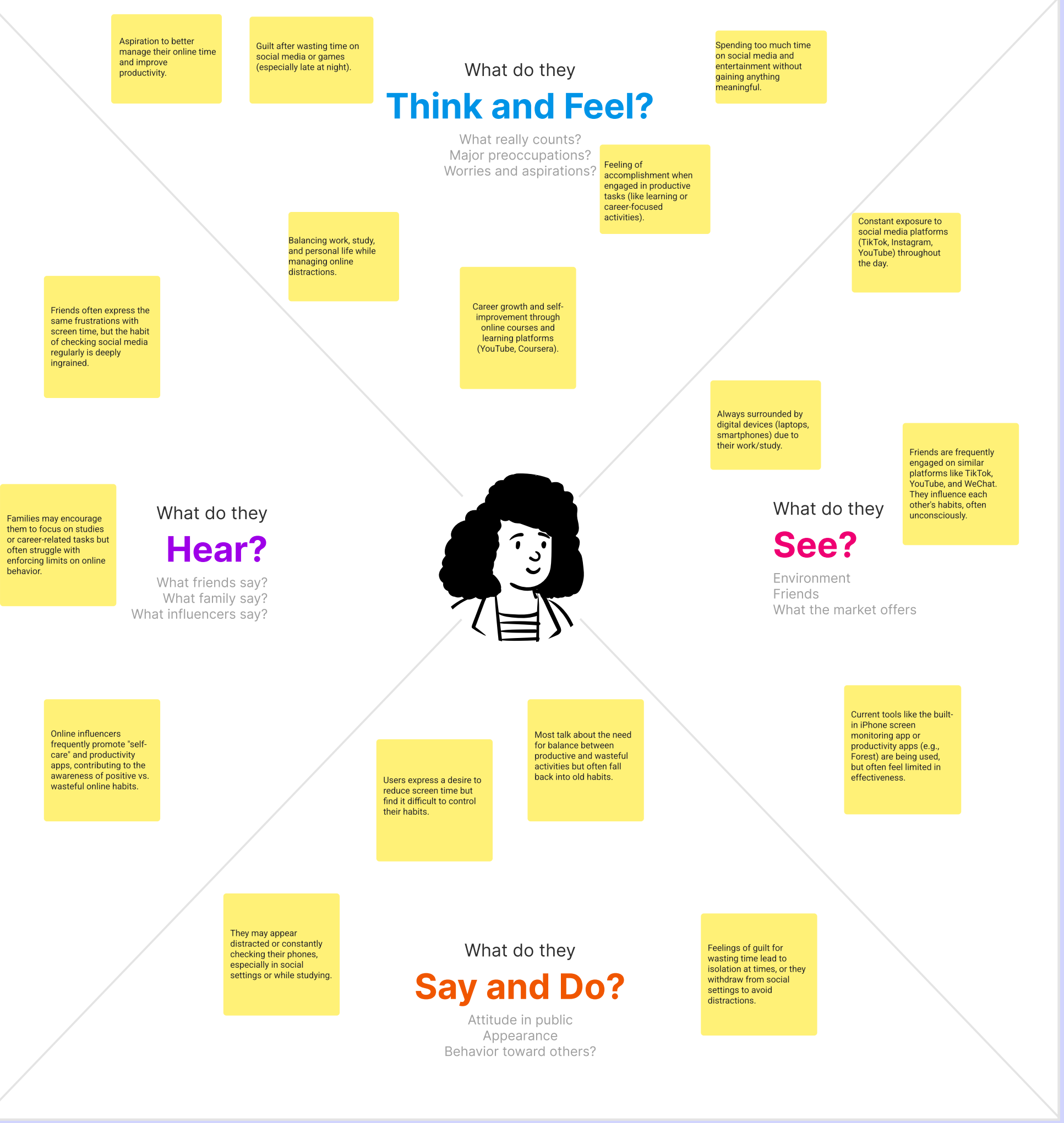
- To understand how users manage distractions and their focus throughout the day.
- To explore what users need to improve their productivity and mental well-being.
- To design an app that helps users cultivate healthy habits for sustained focus.

Questions

1. What tools do you currently use to stay focused or manage distractions?
2. How do you balance productivity with relaxation and sleep?
3. Have you used any productivity or mindfulness apps before? If yes: Which apps? What worked well? What could be improved?
4. What features do you think would help you stay on track with your tasks?
5. How do you feel about features like app blockers, focus timers, and task syncing with Google Calendar?
6. Describe your ideal app for improving focus and productivity.
7. Is there anything else you'd like to add?

What did we learn from interviews?

Emapthy Map



What do they **Think and Feel?**

What really counts?
Major preoccupations?
Worries and aspirations?

- Aspiration to better manage their online time and improve productivity.
- Guilt after wasting time on social media or games (especially late at night).
- Spending too much time on social media and entertainment without gaining anything meaningful.
- Feeling of accomplishment when engaged in productive tasks (like learning or career-focused activities).
- Balancing work, study, and personal life while managing online distractions.
- Career growth and self-improvement through online courses and learning platforms (YouTube, Coursera).

What do they **Hear?**

What friends say?
What family say?
What influencers say?

- Friends often express the same frustrations with screen time, but the habit of checking social media regularly is deeply ingrained.
- Families may encourage them to focus on studies or career-related tasks but often struggle with enforcing limits on online behavior.
- Online influencers frequently promote "self-care" and productivity apps, contributing to the awareness of positive vs. wasteful online habits.

What do they **See?**

Environment
Friends
What the market offers

- Constant exposure to social media platforms (TikTok, Instagram, YouTube) throughout the day.
- Always surrounded by digital devices (laptops, smartphones) due to their work/study.
- Friends are frequently engaged on similar platforms like TikTok, YouTube, and WeChat. They influence each other's habits, often unconsciously.
- Current tools like the built-in iPhone screen monitoring app or productivity apps (e.g., Forest) are being used, but often feel limited in effectiveness.

What do they **Say and Do?**

Attitude in public
Appearance
Behavior toward others?

- Users express a desire to reduce screen time but find it difficult to control their habits.
- Most talk about the need for balance between productive and wasteful activities but often fall back into old habits.
- They may appear distracted or constantly checking their phones, especially in social settings or while studying.
- Feelings of guilt for wasting time lead to isolation at times, or they withdraw from social settings to avoid distractions.

Pains

Fears, frustrations, obstacles...

- Lack of accountability and difficulty in breaking the habit of unconsciously checking apps every few minutes.
- Feeling of wasting time on social media (TikTok, Instagram) or games instead of focusing on personal goals.

Gains

Want/needs, measures of success, achievements

- Users want tools that offer not only time tracking but also tangible rewards or feedback to motivate them (e.g., growing a tree in Forest or actual rewards for staying focused).
- Success is measured by feeling accomplished at the end of the day, especially when tasks are completed, or learning progress is made.

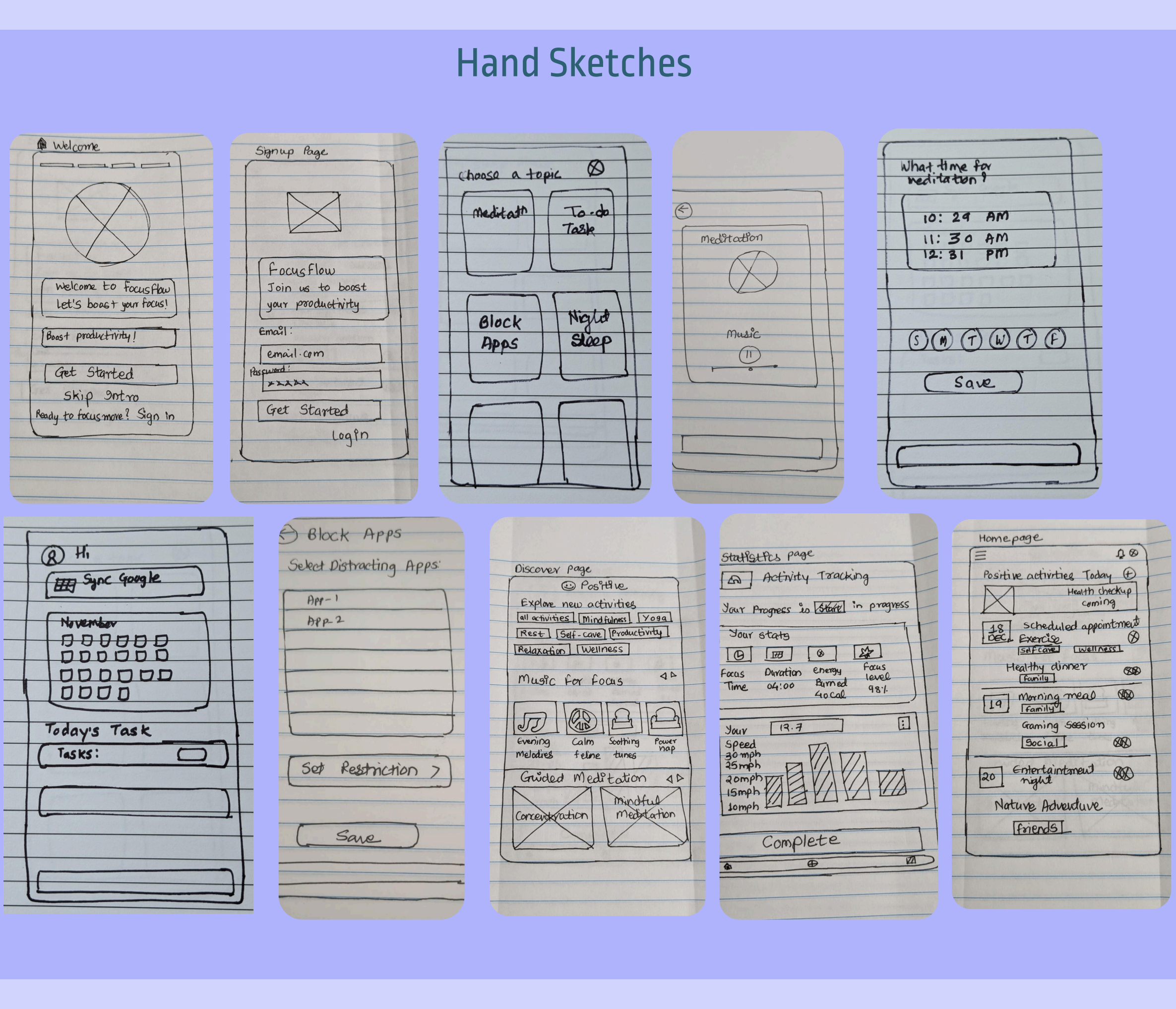
POV Statements

User (or user group)	Needs	Insights
Graduate student, frequent user of social media, feels bad after online gaming, wants career growth.	A tool to block certain apps during study sessions and help him focus on job hunting and learning.	Seeks to spend more time on career development activities, avoid late-night video watching.
Heavy social media user, feels guilty after wasting time on TikTok, wants to manage screen time better.	App that provides time limits and helps her track how much time is wasted on apps like TikTok.	Wants to reduce unconscious phone checking and prioritize constructive online activities.
Uses online platforms for work and entertainment, guilty about unproductive screen time, prefers task breakdown tools like Tomato Clock.	A system that breaks down tasks into smaller intervals with rewards (e.g., growing trees or similar incentives).	Prefers structured breaks and task management tools that provide motivation for productivity.
High social media user, wants to spend more time learning online, uses iPhone app for time management.	A tool to provide notifications and feedback on time spent, especially to reduce unproductive TikTok browsing.	Desires an app that helps reduce guilt by providing constructive alternatives to social media.
Graduate student with similar demographic traits to other users.	He likely needs a method to balance study and online social activities.	He seeks balance between productive and leisure online time.

Crafting a Solution

Hand sketches of possible solutions for FocusFlow's main features, including meditation prompts, a calendar-to-do system, app blocker options, and night sleep mode.

Hand Sketches


Welcome
Welcome to focusflow
Let's boost your focus!
Boost productivity!
Get Started
Skip Intro
Ready to focus more? Sign In
Signup Page
FocusFlow
Join us to boost your productivity
Email:
email.com
Password:
Get Started
Login
Choose a topic
Meditatn
To-do Task
Block Apps
Night Sleep
Meditation
Music
What time for meditation?
10: 29 AM
11: 30 AM
12: 31 PM
S M T W T F
Save
Hi
Sync Google
November
Today's Task
Tasks:
Block Apps
Select Distracting Apps
App-1
App-2
Set Restriction
Save
Discover Page
Positive
Explore new activities
all activities
Mindfulness
Yoga
Rest
Self-care
Productivity
Relaxation
Wellness
Music for focus
Evening melodies
Calm feline
Soothing tunes
Power nap
Guided Meditation
Concentration
Mindful Meditation
Statistics page
Activity Tracking
Your Progress
in progress
Your stats
Focus Time
Duration 04:00
Energy Burned 40 Cal
Focus level 98%
Your Speed
30 mph
25 mph
20 mph
15 mph
10 mph
19.7
Complete
Home page
Positive activities Today
Health checkup coming
18 DEC
Scheduled appointment
Exercise
Self care
Wellness
Healthy dinner
19
Morning meal
Family
Gaming session
Social
20
Entertainment night
Nature Adventure
friends

Why Hand Sketches: Quick thoughts for solution

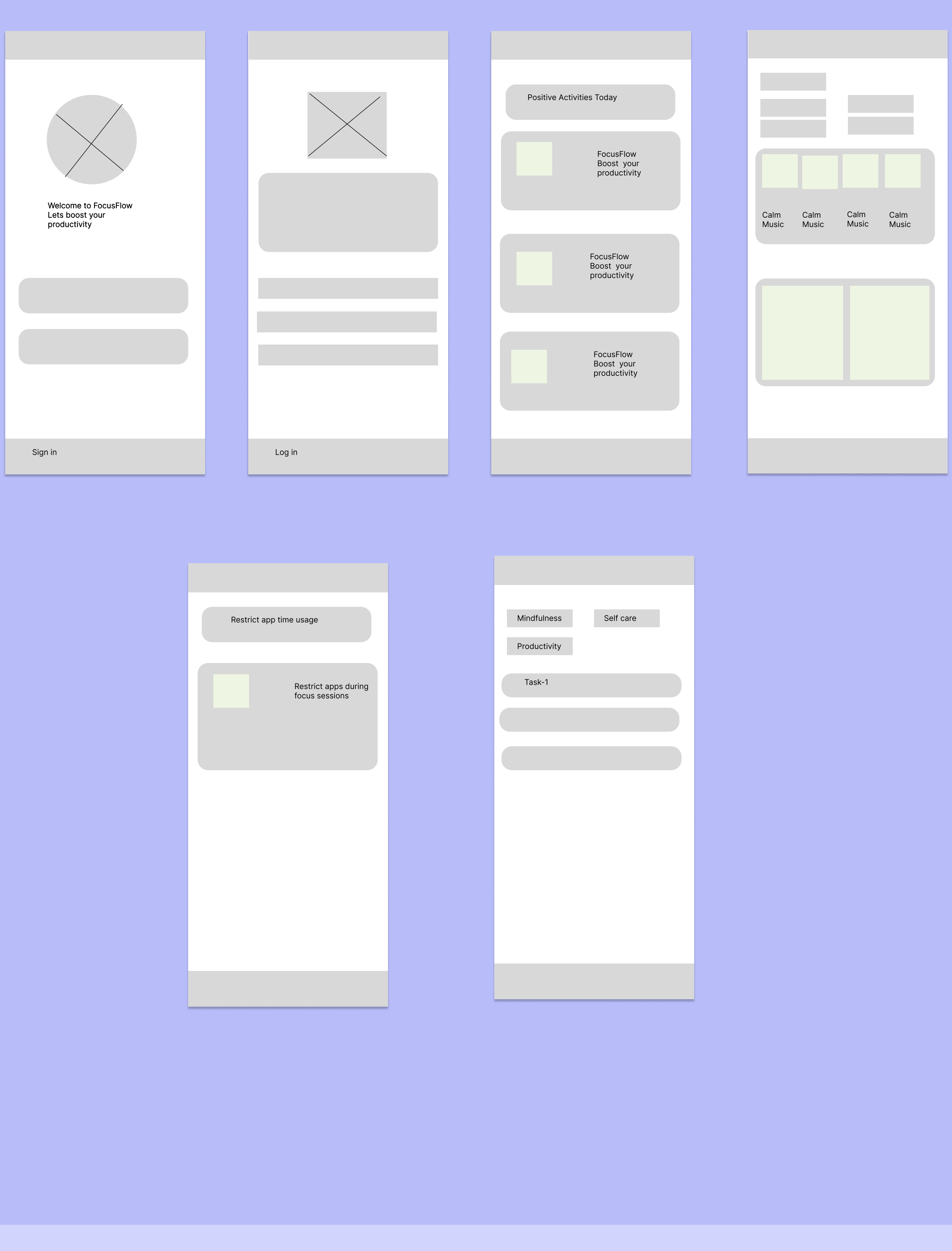
Sketching helped me quickly capture initial ideas for a simple, engaging design.

Design Vision: Friendly, intuitive, calming

Core Features:

- Meditation and music for mindfulness
- Calendar-based task management
- App blocking for distraction-free time
- Night sleep mode with soothing sounds

Wireframes: All grey for layout


Welcome to FocusFlow
Lets boost your productivity
Sign in
Log in
Positive Activities Today
FocusFlow
Boost your productivity
FocusFlow
Boost your productivity
FocusFlow
Boost your productivity
Calm Music
Calm Music
Calm Music
Calm Music
Restrict app time usage
Restrict apps during focus sessions
Mindfulness
Self care
Productivity
Task-1

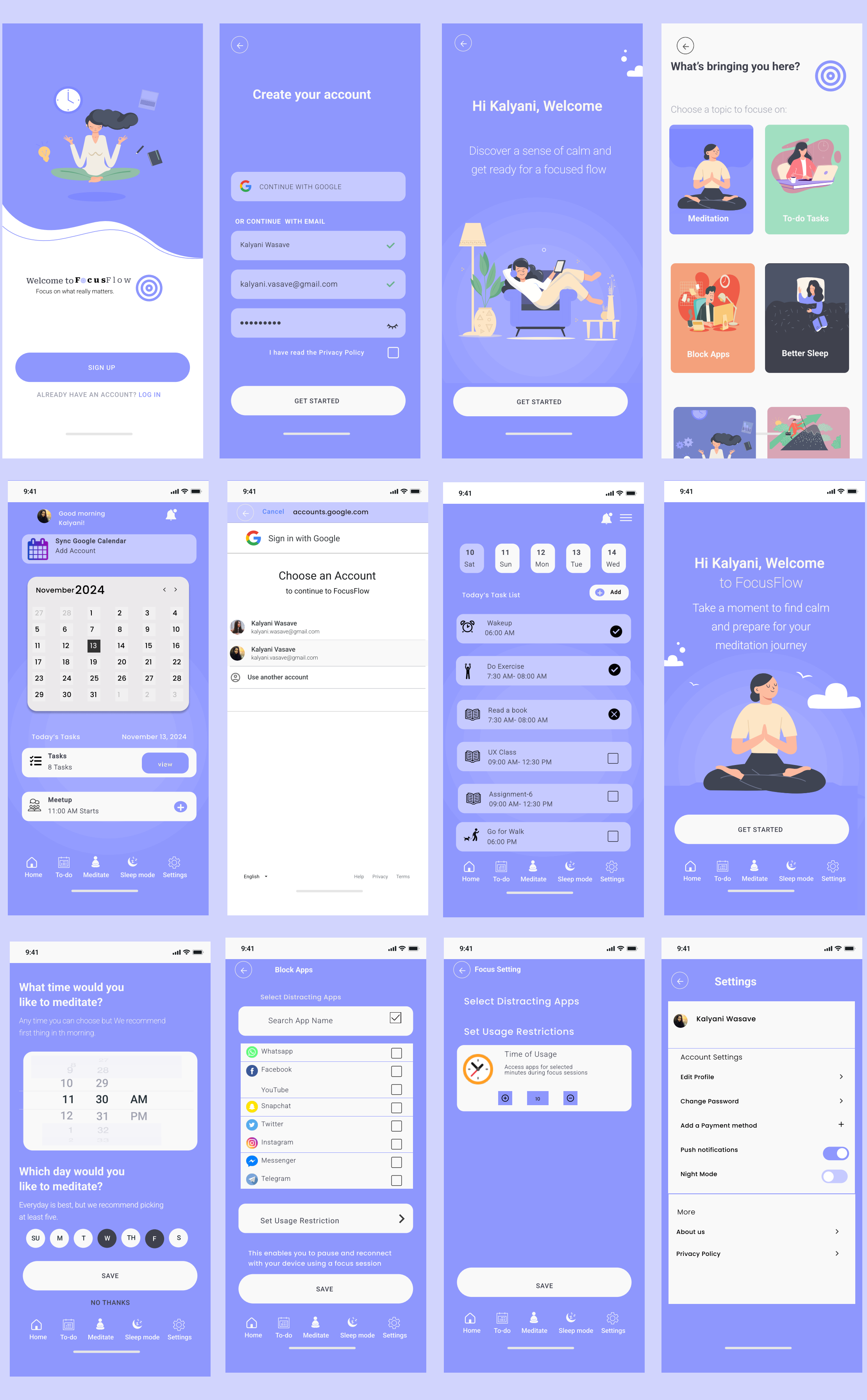
High Fidelity Prototypes

Design Aesthetic:

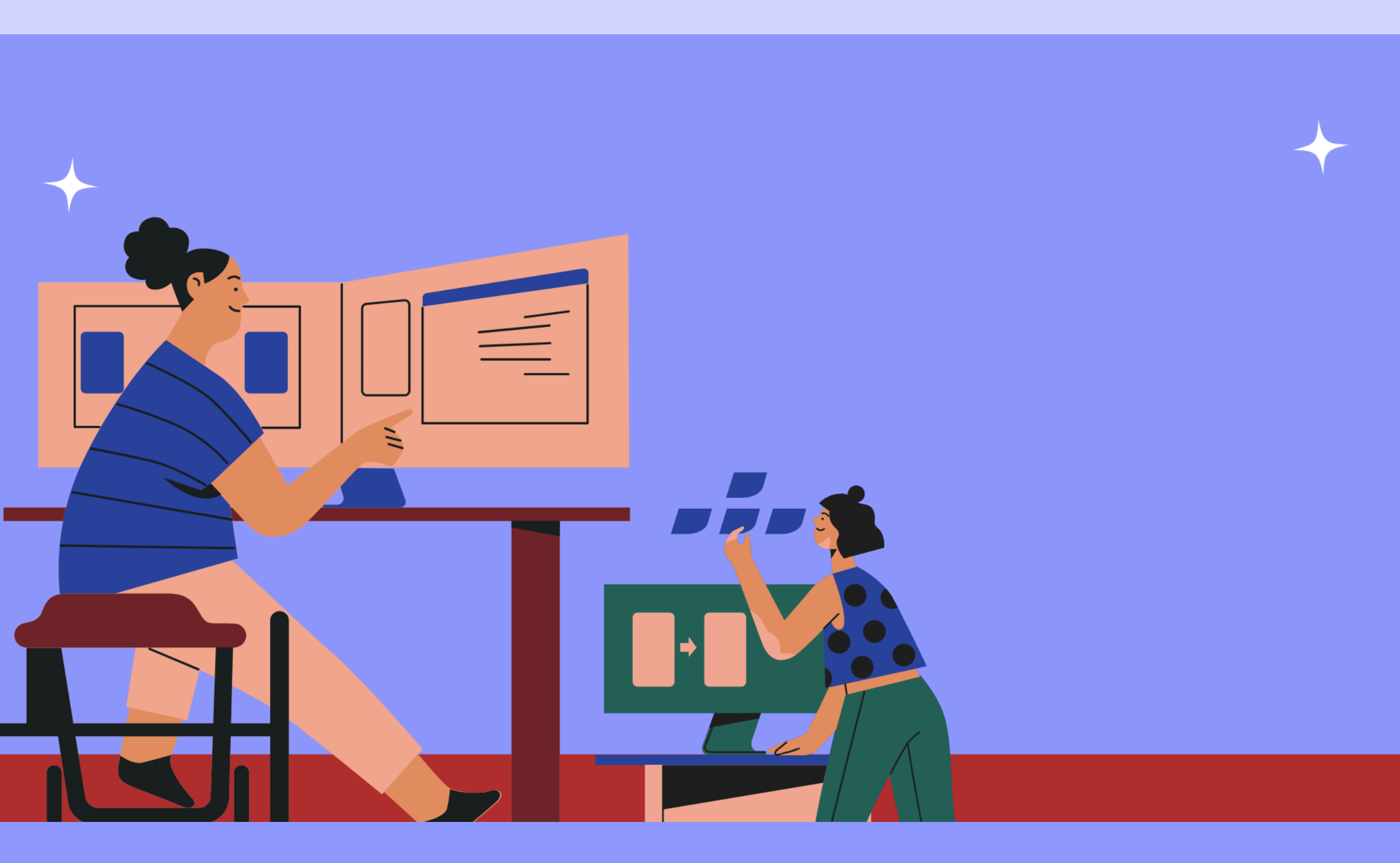
The FocusFlow design uses calming colors, simple layouts, and easy navigation to help users feel at ease while using the app.

Main Features:

- Meditation feature with progress tracking
- Task Calendar with Google Calendar sync
- App Blocker with restricted usage
- Night Sleep Mode with music duration settings


Welcome to FocusFlow
Focus on what really matters.
SIGN UP
ALREADY HAVE AN ACCOUNT? LOG IN
Create your account
CONTINUE WITH GOOGLE
OR CONTINUE WITH EMAIL
Kalyani Wasave
kalyani.vasave@gmail.com
I have read the Privacy Policy
GET STARTED
Hi Kalyani, Welcome
Discover a sense of calm and get ready for a focused flow
GET STARTED
What's bringing you here?
Choose a topic to focuse on:
Meditation
To-do Tasks
Block Apps
Better Sleep
9:41
Good morning Kalyani!
Sync Google Calendar
Add Account
November 2024
Today's Tasks
November 13, 2024
Tasks
8 Tasks
view
Meetup
11:00 AM Starts
Home
To-do
Meditate
Sleep mode
Settings
Cancel
accounts.google.com
Sign in with Google
Choose an Account
to continue to FocusFlow
Kalyani Wasave
Kalyani Vasave
Use another account
English
Help
Privacy
Terms
10 Sat
11 Sun
12 Mon
13 Tue
14 Wed
Today's Task List
Add
Wakeup 06:00 AM
Do Exercise 7:30 AM- 08:00 AM
Read a book 7:30 AM- 08:00 AM
UX Class 09:00 AM- 12:30 PM
Assignment-6 09:00 AM- 12:30 PM
Go for Walk 06:00 PM
Hi Kalyani, Welcome to FocusFlow
Take a moment to find calm and prepare for your meditation journey
GET STARTED
What time would you like to meditate?
Any time you can choose but We recommend first thing in th morning.
10 29
11 30 AM
12 31 PM
Which day would you like to meditate?
Everyday is best, but we recommend picking at least five.
SU M T W TH F S
SAVE
NO THANKS
Block Apps
Select Distracting Apps
Search App Name
Whatsapp
Facebook
YouTube
Snapchat
Twitter
Instagram
Messenger
Telegram
Set Usage Restriction
This enables you to pause and reconnect with your device using a focus session
SAVE
Focus Setting
Select Distracting Apps
Set Usage Restrictions
Time of Usage
Access apps for selected minutes during focus sessions
SAVE
Settings
Kalyani Wasave
Account Settings
Edit Profile
Change Password
Add a Payment method
Push notifications
Night Mode
More
About us
Privacy Policy

[Prototype Link]



Define the testing task lists: All features

Designed FocusFlow to help users manage focus-

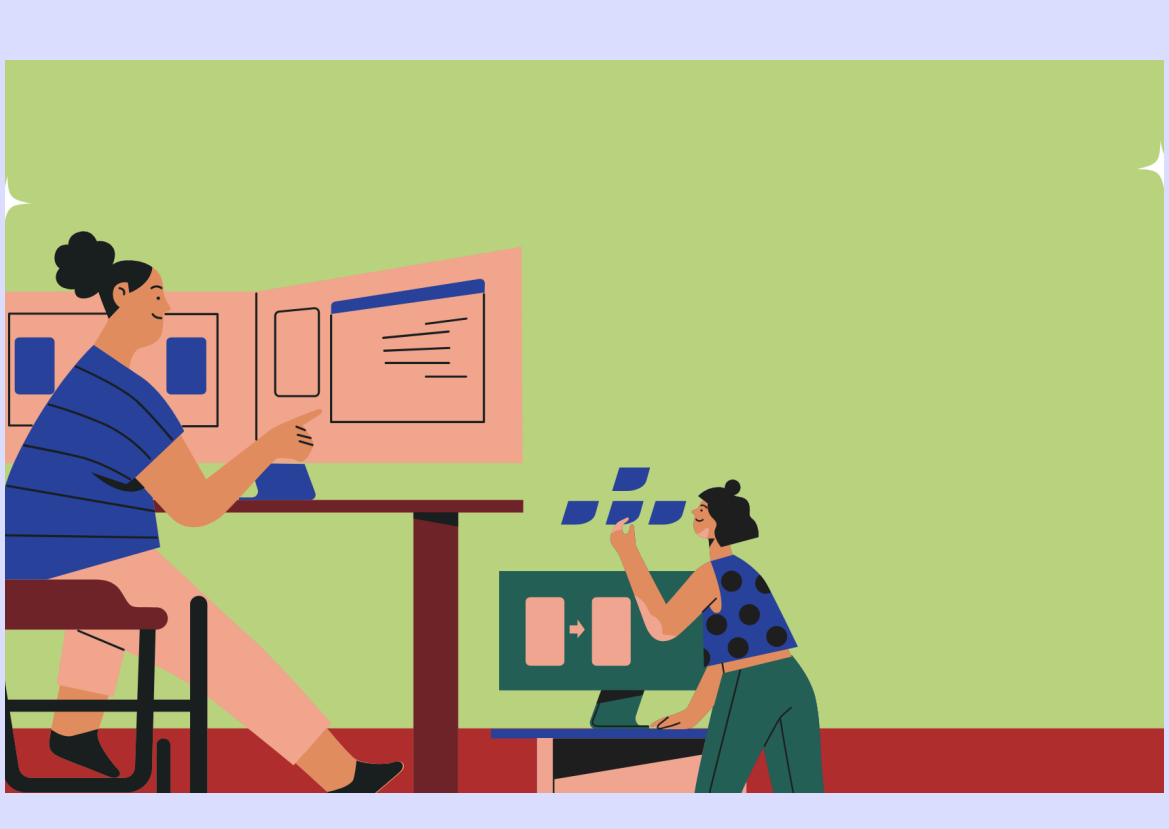
- Log In/Sign Up
- Start a meditation session
- Add tasks and sync with Google Calendar
- Use the App Blocker to restrict apps
- Set up and use Night Sleep Mode

Usability Testing Results

A matrix summarizing interview feedback, identifying effective areas and areas for improvement.

	Task-1:Explore and set up Meditation feature	Task-2:Add and sync tasks in Calendar-To-Do feature	Task-3: Block distracting apps using Block App feature
Participant-1	Meditation setup is easy to follow. Timer option and music selection are straightforward, but they suggested making the "Set Daily Reminder" button more noticeable.	Task addition is clear, but syncing with Google Calendar could use a step-by-step guide for first-time users. Found the sync status indicator useful.	Block App feature works well. Restricted usage option was confusing initially, but once understood, they appreciated the flexibility.
Participant-2	Simple and calming interface. Enjoyed the guided reminders for habit formation, but would like more customization in meditation music.	Syncing with Google Calendar is convenient. Suggested adding task categories (e.g., Work, Personal) for better organization.	Loved the feature. Restricted usage option is helpful but suggested adding an option to block by time (e.g., blocking apps from 9am-5pm).
Participant-3	Design is clear and easy to use. Recommended adding a short tutorial for new users to better understand meditation setup options.	Adding tasks is easy, but syncing took a bit longer than expected. Recommended adding a prompt to check sync status.	Found the Block App feature useful. Initially confused by "Restricted Usage," but once clarified, found it helpful for urgent updates on blocked apps.
Participant-4	Everything works smoothly. Suggested making the meditation timer more prominent. Found the design calming and motivating for regular use.	Task management is user-friendly, but Google sync needs clearer instructions. Appreciated the ability to view tasks by priority.	Effective for reducing distractions. Liked the flexibility of restricted access, but recommended clearer labeling on setup.
Participant-5	Enjoys the simplicity. Suggested making the "Select Days" option clearer for setting up a meditation schedule. Found music selection relaxing.	Found it easy to navigate. Would appreciate more visual cues for synced tasks. Suggested adding recurring tasks feature.	Block App feature is good. Restricted usage option could benefit from preset options (e.g., "5 mins," "15 mins") for ease of use.

Conclusion



What went well?

- Simple, intuitive layout that supports focus and relaxation.
- User-friendly navigation that aligns with user goals for productivity and mindfulness.
- Interview feedback and testing sessions were valuable in refining the app's features.

What could be improved?

- Interviewing more diverse users to gain insights across various lifestyles and productivity needs.
- Reducing complexity in the calendar and app-blocking settings based on feedback.
- Expanding features to include weekly productivity tracking and personalized recommendations for focus and relaxation.

Whats Next?

- Adding interactive features like productivity reports and focus challenges.
- Developing a community space for shared mindfulness and productivity tips.
- Including a feature to visualize weekly productivity and focus trends.